

ENGL251 – Midterm – VA - AK

Part One: Objective Component (20 points)

1. Choose the correct answer. (10 points)

(2 points for every correct answer)

1. What should you eliminate in your writing to make it more concise?
 - A. Relevant details
 - B. Flabby expressions**
 - C. Main ideas
 - D. Proper punctuation
2. What are key technological trends in Business Communication?
 - A. Fax and landlines
 - B. Mobile and cloud computing**
 - C. Postal mail
 - D. Bulletin boards
3. What should you use for presenting information in the body of your email?
 - A. Long paragraphs
 - B. Extremely short sentences
 - C. Bulleted or numbered lists**
 - D. Only images
4. What is the first phase of the 3-X-3 writing process?
 - A. Drafting
 - B. Revising
 - C. Prewriting**
 - D. Editing
5. Which aspect of communication involves understanding messages without words?
 - A. Verbal
 - B. Nonverbal**
 - C. Symbols
 - D. Short messages

2. Answer by True or False. Correct the False statements. (10 points)

For True statements, 2 points for every correct answer.

For False statements: 1 point for False. 1 point for correcting the False statement.

1. Time orientation is a universal concept, unaffected by culture. **False. Time orientation is a cultural concept and it varies from one culture to another.**
2. Companies should only focus on traditional direct mail and ignore social/digital marketing.
3. Sales letters are a part of a package with various persuasive elements. **True**
4. A buffer in an indirect negative message should include false impressions to make the news seem less bad. **False. A buffer in an indirect negative message should include honest impressions but they should be presented in a nice and considerate manner.**
5. A compound sentence contains two complete but related thoughts. **True**

Part Two: Reading a Business Message Critically (20 points)

1. How does the email capture the reader's attention in the opening? Is it effective? (5 points)
The email captures the reader's attention by presenting an "exciting opportunity" right at the beginning. The use of words like "esteemed" and "exciting" suggests value and respect for the recipient's company. It is effective as it immediately communicates a potential benefit for Ms. Ramirez's company, Global Dynamics.
2. What is the main message of the email? (5 points)
The main message of the email is an invitation for Global Dynamics to form a partnership with Innovative Solutions Ltd. This partnership is based on the belief that Innovative Solutions' state-of-the-art software solutions can enhance and benefit Global Dynamics' current services.
3. Does the email use direct or indirect approach? Explain. (5 points)
The email uses a direct approach. This is evident as the initial sentences of the email directly present the main idea - an exclusive partnership opportunity. There's no beating around the bush; the proposition is stated upfront.
4. How effective is the email's call to action? Does it provide a clear next step for the recipient? (5 points)
The email's call to action is effective. It proposes a clear next step: scheduling a virtual meeting the following week to discuss the potential collaboration. The writer asks Ms. Ramirez to specify a convenient time, making it easy for her to respond and take action.

Part Three: Proofreading and Rewriting a Business Message (10 points)

Rubric for Rewriting Exercise (Total: 10 points)

- **Tone and Professionalism (3 points):**
 - Email uses appropriate and consistent professional language throughout (1 point).
 - The tone is empathetic, understanding the sensitivity of the message (1 point).
 - There's a clear shift from the casual tone of the original to a more formal one in the rewrite (1 point).
- **Clarity and Organization (3 points):**
 - The subject line is clear and relevant to the content of the email (1 point).
 - The message is structured logically, with an introduction, main content, and a courteous closing (1 point).
 - The rewrite clearly communicates the negative news without ambiguity (1 point).
- **Error Correction (2 points):**
 - Language errors from the original email are corrected (1 point).
 - The rewrite is free from any new grammatical or spelling errors (1 point).
- **Persuasive and Supportive Elements (2 points):**
 - The rewrite emphasizes the company's regret and the gravity of the decision (1 point).
 - The message includes an offer of support or transparency, showing concern for the employees' well-being and potential questions (1 point).

Part Four: Writing a Business Message (50 points)

This rubric applies for both prompts as both of them require the direct approach.

Rubric for Writing Exercise (Total: 50 points):

- **Content (20 points):**
 - The email addresses the main issue directly (5 points).
 - It provides clear reasons or circumstances leading to the negative news (5 points).
 - Offers potential solutions, recommendations, or alternative courses of action where applicable (5 points).
 - Expresses genuine concern or regret for any inconvenience caused (5 points).
- **Tone and Professionalism (10 points):**
 - Uses appropriate and consistent professional language throughout the email (5 points).
 - The tone is empathetic and shows understanding of the recipient's potential concerns or disappointments (5 points).
- **Clarity (10 points):**
 - The message conveys the negative news without ambiguity (5 points).
 - The email is free from grammatical or spelling errors (5 points).
- **Organization (10 points):**
 - The email is structured logically with an introduction, main content, and a courteous closing (5 points).
 - Information is presented in a manner that is easy for the recipient to understand and follow (5 points).